The Noble King of Vidyā-Mantras Called "Great Breath"

Āryamahāśvāsanāmavidyārāja · Toh 969 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་རིག་སྔགས་ཀྱི་རྒྱལ་པོ་དོན་གྱས་ཆེན་པོ་ཞེས་བྱ།

The Noble King of Vidyā-Mantras Called "Great Breath" is a short scripture whose Tibetan title opens with the words 'phags pa rig sngags kyi, "noble... of vidyā-mantras." Its full Sanskrit original is not securely attested, so it is best known by its English rendering. The text is a protective incantation, set as a dialogue in which Daṃṣṭrākarālapiṅgala, the fearsome lord of the bhūtas and sovereign of the four continents, addresses the Buddha. He describes his power to harm and bind spirits and to send forth a great hungry breath that saps the vitality of humans and nonhumans and spreads fevers through the world. He then turns to the protective efficacy of this king of vidyā-mantras, which guards against such afflictions wherever it is present. The work is Toh 969 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the collected dhāraṇī and mantra texts valued for healing and protection from harmful spirits and disease.

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Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Then the great lord of the bhūtas, the sovereign of the four continents, the one called Daṃṣṭrākarālapiṅgala, said this to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, I am the lord of all the bhūtas. I harm, strike and bind all the bhūtas who dwell in the world-system of the four continents. I hurl them from this world-system into other world-systems, and I cut off their limbs, both major and minor. Blessed One, whenever I grow hungry, I let out a breath, and that breath fills the whole world-system of the four continents. Blessed One, I steal the vitality of all humans and nonhumans, and as soon as the great breath touches sentient beings, all kinds of fevers arise.

"Blessed One, wherever this king of vidyā-mantras called Great Breath is practiced, my breath will not prevail there, and the bhūtas will not cause harm. Any son or daughter of good family who pays homage to the Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha, and then ties this on the head or at the neck and wears it, will not be struck by fevers arising from wind, from bile, from phlegm, or from their combination. From this day on I make this pledge in the presence of the Tathāgata."

tadyathā ḍara ḍara ḍaḍara ḍaḍara thara thara thathara thathara mara mara mamara mamara dhuhu dhuhu hahaha sara sara sara cucucu bububu kili kili kili sarba bhāta adhipati dra dra dra bra bra bra gu gu gu kra kra kra yasa yasa yasa pāṇḍare pāṇḍare hulu hulu hulu huhuhu Protect me! Protect me! cili cili cili mili mili mili khśo khśo khśo gauri gauri gauri May all my illnesses be completely pacified! svāhā mahāśvāsāya svāhā mahābhūta adhibataye svāhā gauriye svāhā ugrāya svāhā May I be well! daṃṣṭrīkarāla biṅgala ājñā bayati svāhā

This completes the Noble King of Vidyā-Mantras Called "Great Breath."

It was translated, edited and finalized by the Indian preceptor Prajñāvarman and the chief editor-translator, the monk Yeshé Dé.

Translator's Notes

• The name of the lord of bhūtas, Tibetan "Tawny Bared-Fangs," is given in Sanskrit as Daṃṣṭrākarālapiṅgala. This form is reconstructed from the closing mantra line, which reads "daṃṣṭrīkarāla biṅgala" ("terrible with fangs, tawny"). The exact Sanskrit form is not otherwise attested here and remains tentative. The word translated "fevers" refers to a class of febrile or epidemic illnesses.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.